5.10.3 to(position)

Returns the substring of the string up to position position:

```
"hello".to(0)  # => "h"
"hello".to(2)  # => "hel"
"hello".to(-2) # => "hell"
"hello".to(10) # => "hello"
```

Defined in active_support/core_ext/string/access.rb.

5.10.4 first(limit = 1)

The call str.first(n) is equivalent to str.to(n-1) if n > 0, and returns an empty string for n == 0.

Defined in active_support/core_ext/string/access.rb.

5.10.5 last(limit = 1)

The call str.last(n) is equivalent to str.from(-n) if n > 0, and returns an empty string for n == 0.

Defined in active_support/core_ext/string/access.rb.

5.11 Inflections

5.11.1 pluralize

The method pluralize returns the plural of its receiver:

```
"table".pluralize     # => "tables"
"ruby".pluralize      # => "rubies"
"equipment".pluralize # => "equipment"
```

As the previous example shows, Active Support knows some irregular plurals and uncountable nouns.

Built-in rules can be extended in config/initializers/inflections.rb. That file is generated by the rails command and has instructions in comments.

pluralize can also take an optional count parameter. If count == 1 the singular form will be returned.

For any other value of count the plural form will be returned:

```
"dude".pluralize(0) # => "dudes"
"dude".pluralize(1) # => "dude"
"dude".pluralize(2) # => "dudes"
```

Active Record uses this method to compute the default table name that corresponds to a model:

```
# active_record/model_schema.rb
def undecorated_table_name(class_name = base_class.name)
  table_name = class_name.to_s.demodulize.underscore
  pluralize_table_names ? table_name.pluralize : table_name
end
```

Defined in active_support/core_ext/string/inflections.rb.

5.11.2 singularize

The inverse of pluralize:

```
"tables".singularize    # => "table"
"rubies".singularize    # => "ruby"
"equipment".singularize # => "equipment"
```

Associations compute the name of the corresponding default associated class using this method:

```
# active_record/reflection.rb
def derive_class_name
  class_name = name.to_s.camelize
  class_name = class_name.singularize if collection?
  class_name
end
```

Defined in active_support/core_ext/string/inflections.rb.

5.11.3 camelize

The method camelize returns its receiver in camel case: